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Windows 11 Deployment – Using MDT 8456 with Windows



By Johan Arwidmark / February 14, 2025

Since Microsoft don't officially support Windows 11 Deployments with MDT, nor supporting any Windows newer than Windows ADK for Windows 10, version 1809 (build 17763), it's up to the OSD community. On the good side, with millions of MDT downloads during the years, you're not exactly alone 😊

NOTE: Build 26100 (24H2 ADK) does work with MDT, with the workarounds listed in this post, but has PowerShell and servicing bugs. For now, I recommend sticking with ADK 22H2 build 22621.

Food for thought

As of this writing, the by Microsoft only supported deployment solution for Windows 11 is ConfigMgr. With a few tweaks, you can absolutely make MDT work for Windows 11, and even use the latest Windows ADK for Windows 11 24H2).

Fun fact: You can deploy Windows 11 just fine with an older ADK version too, but you will find that the

chipset support is not the best. I recommending using at least Windows ADK for Windows 11 22H2 (E

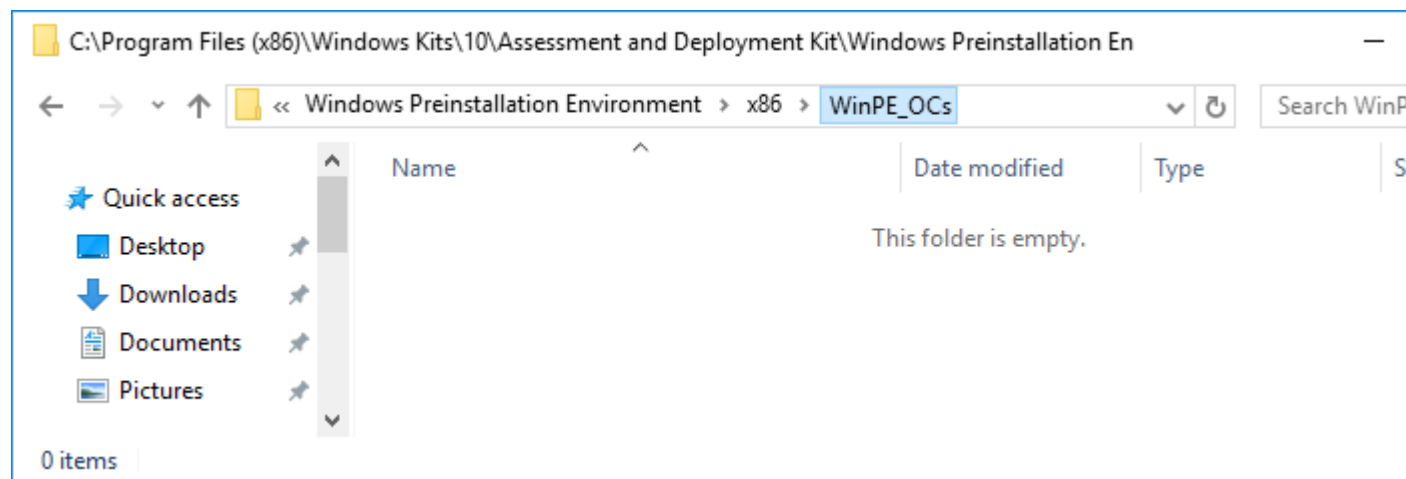
Issue #1 – WinPE x86 is Missing

The fact that Microsoft no longer includes the 32-bit (x86) version of WinPE is not exactly new, it was Windows ADK for Windows 11 22H2 (Build 22621), but MDT expects to find an x86WinPE_OC's fold Windows ADK installation folder. If MDT can't find that, the console crashes with an exception:

System.IO.DirectoryNotFoundException. Could not find a part of the path 'C:\Program Files (x86)\Windows Kits\10\Assessment and Deployment Kit\Windows Preinstallation Environment\x86\WinPE_OC's'

Solution: Create an empty x86\WinPE_OC's folder structure in the Windows ADK folder. MDT don't c content; it just looks for the folder 😊 Here is a PowerShell snippet.

```
$OCx86Path = "C:\Program Files (x86)\Windows Kits\10\Assessment and Deployment  
New-Item -Path $OCx86Path -ItemType Directory -Force
```



Creating the empty x86WinPE_OC's folder structure.

Issue #2 – Generating Catalog Files will Fail

If you try generating a catalog for a WIM image using the latest Windows ADK, MDT will crash with th message:

Unhandled Exception: System.IO.FileNotFoundException: Could not load file or assembly 'Microsoft.ComponentStudio.ComponentPlatformInterface, Version=6.2.0.0, Culture=neutral, PublicKeyToken=31bf3856ad364e35' or one of its dependencies. The system cannot find the file spe

This is due to the fact that the latest Windows ADK is the first version to include architecture specific Windows System Image Manager (WSIM). Earlier versions only had x86 versions.

Solution: Edit the **C:\Program Files\Microsoft Deployment Toolkit\Bin\DeploymentTools.xml** file and set the **%RealPlatform%** value for the imgmgr.exe tool. Thank you **L. Ozon** for providing this elegant workaround. The edited line should look like:

```
<tool name="imgmgr.exe">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\WSIM\%RealPlatform%</tool>
```

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Johan Arwidmark

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25 COMMENTS



Matheos 2 months ago

Can I please have the mdt 8456? Is not available anymore to download.

+ 0 - Reply



Author

Johan Arwidmark 2 months ago

Reply to [Matheos](#)

You can still find MDT on the wayback machine (Internet archive), https://web.archive.org/web/20240315155222/https://download.microsoft.com/download/3/3/9/339BE62B58D-73C4685FC492/MicrosoftDeploymentToolkit_x64.msi

+ 3 - Reply



Matheos 2 months ago

Reply to [Johan Arwidmark](#)

Thank you very much!

+ 1 - Reply



Veselin 2 months ago

Reply to [Johan Arwidmark](#)

Hm, are you sure the link works? All i get is error 503.

+ 0 - Reply



Author

Johan Arwidmark 2 months ago

Reply to [Veselin](#)

Worked for me just now (January 29,2026)

+ 0 - Reply



L. Ozon 6 months ago

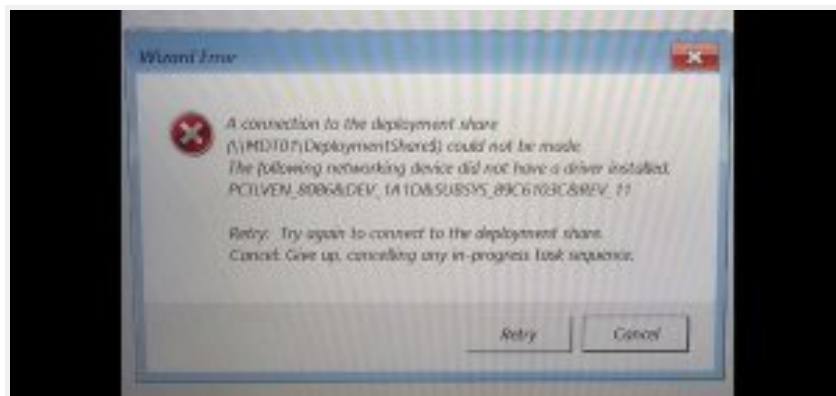
LTI deployment issue with windows recovery. When deploying an edition of windows (pro, enterprise, etc.) from install.wim, it uses the winre.wim file for the specific edition, which includes any drivers for the hardware (or virtualization platform, especially if you're using a virtualization platform). What that means is that due to missing drivers, Windows Recovery Environment is unable to access the various devices due to missing drivers. The solution is: Determine the specific edition in install.wim that will be deployed, and mount it in the mount folder, local path "Windows\System32\Recovery\Winre.wim" and mount it to another... [Read more »](#)

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John 9 months ago

I keep getting this. Boot into pxe, the wizard starts and as it looks like its applying custom drivers it throws out the same error each time. I'm using the latest adk, mdt, win pe. I am testing with a Zbook Fury 16 G9 laptop but have a few varieties of Zbooks (not yet tested). I found the latest drivers and imported into mdt and regenerated the boot image. I restarted WDS, I removed boot images and reloaded, just keep getting this. It will not move past this. Please help. I'm pulling my hair out in frustration.



+ 0 — ➔ Reply



Johan Arwidmark 2 months ago

➔ Reply to [John](#)

Author

Try using drvload.exe with the driver, and then run wpeinit.exe... Good for verifying that the driver is added.

+ 0 — ➔ Reply



JimmyH 9 months ago

Having updated to Windows ADK 24H2 (Build 26100) and matching PE Components to...

Windows 11 24H2, the task sequence works but we get a warning with the message: Unable to find the Results.xml file needed to determine the deployment results. (This may be the result of using older script versions. Ensure all boot images have been updated.) I've deleted and regenerated the boot images and made sure WDS is using them. I don't seem to be able to find much, if anything, on the internet about people experiencing this issue. The file it looks for appears to be in the c:\windows\temp.

+ 0 - ➔ Reply



Johan Arwidmark ⌚ 2 months ago

➔ Reply to [JimmyH](#)

Author

Sorry, nothing that rings a bell

+ 0 - ➔ Reply



Michel ⌚ 9 months ago

Sadly this fix doesn't work anymore with the latest current version. You get the same message: The fix doesn't work anymore.

+ 0 - ➔ Reply



Johan Arwidmark ⌚ 2 months ago

➔ Reply to [Michel](#)

Author

Sorry for the very late reply.... I've been successful with Windows ADK 24H2, are you still having the issue?

+ 0 - ➔ Reply



John Touma ⌚ 1 year ago

This is what worked for me in version ADK 10.1.26100.2454 (December 2024). I added the following to the DeploymentTools.xml

```
<tool name="imgmgr.exe">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\Windows\Deployment Tools\%RealPlatform%\BCDBoot</tool>
<tool name="imagecat.exe">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\WSIM\amd64</tool>
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="utf-8" ?>
<Kits>
  <ADK>
    <tool name="bcdboot.exe">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\%RealPlatform%\BCDBoot</tool>
    <tool name="bcdedit.exe">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\%RealPlatform%\BCDBoot</tool>
    <tool name="bootsect.exe">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\%RealPlatform%\BCDBoot</tool>
    <tool name="dism.exe">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\%RealPlatform%\DISM</tool>
    <tool name="imagex.exe">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\%RealPlatform%\DISM</tool>
    <tool name="wimgapi.dll">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\%RealPlatform%\DISM</tool>
    <tool name="wimgapi.dll.mui">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\%RealPlatform%\DISM\en-us</tool>
    <tool name="oscdimg.exe">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\%RealPlatform%\OSCDIMG</tool>
    <tool name="wdsmlcast.exe">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\%RealPlatform%\WDSMCast</tool>
  </ADK>
</Kits>
```

```
name="wdsimcast.exe.mui">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\%RealPlatform%\WDSMC
tool> <tool name="winpe.wim">%ADKPath%\Windows Preinstallation Environment\
%RealPlatform%\en-us</tool> <tool name="imgmgr.exe">%ADKPath%\Deployment
Tools\WSIM\amd64</tool> <tool name="imagecat.exe">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tool
tool> <tool name="imagecat.exe">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\WSIM\amd64</tool
name="scanstate.exe">%ADKPath%\User State Migration Tool\%RealPlatform%</tool>
name="loadstate.exe">%ADKPath%\User State Migration Tool\%RealPlatform%</tool>
name="bootmgr">%ADKPath%\Windows Preinstallation Environment\%RealPlatform%
tool> <tool name="etfsboot.com">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\%RealPlatform%\O
tool> <tool name="efisys.bin">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\%RealPlatform%\OSCI
<tool name="efisys_noprompt.bin">%ADKPath%\Deployment Tools\%RealPlatform%\
tool> </ADK>... Read more »
```

 Last edited 1 year ago by John Touma

+ 0 —  Reply



Jaturong  1 year ago

I have a problem deploying the image as shown in the picture. I am not sure what went wrong, please help me.



+ 0 —  Reply



Author

Johan Arwidmark  1 year ago

 Reply to [Jaturong](#)

I'll need a bit more information to help with that.

- If you press F8, does the machine have an IP address?
- What version of Windows ADK are you using?
- Can you reproduce the issue in a virtual machine?

+ 0 —  Reply



Jaturong Yaites 1 year ago

[Reply to Johan Arwidmark](#)

- If you press F8, does the machine have an IP address?

Yes, i check cmd: ipconfig /all and i have ip.

- What version of Windows ADK are you using?

ADK 10.1.26100.2454

ADK WinPE 10.1.26100.24.54

MDT 6.3.8456.1000

- Can you reproduce the issue in a virtual machine?

I can fix on production.

I use windows 11 Pro 24H2

+ 0 - [Reply](#)



Author

Johan Arwidmark 1 year ago

[Reply to Jaturong Yaites](#)

Might be worth trying an older, and more tested, ADK like the 22H2 version.

+ 0 - [Reply](#)



Mike Walter 1 year ago

Thanks for all of the detailed guides. Ive just started working with 24H2, and with the new MDT. I've noticed the LiteTouch boot image (without drivers) is over 600mb in size, and the 500MB boot device and crashes the whole sequence. Any ideas how to resolve the LiteTouch size?

+ 0 - [Reply](#)



Author

Johan Arwidmark 1 year ago

[Reply to Mike Walter](#)

There is no 500 MB limit that I'm aware of... we have customers with MDT boot image in the 700-800 MB range using it for all sorts of hardware. I've never only seen an issue like the LiteTouch boot image when deploying a VM that is configured for dynamic memory (don't). What errors are you seeing?

+ 0 - [Reply](#)



Mike Walter 1 year ago

[Reply to Johan Arwidmark](#)

It appears you are correct. I was reviewing logs and it appeared the Lite Touch boot image was failing. I ended up finding that even though BitLocker was turned off, that there's

setting for drive encryption that has to be turned off as well. Once that was turned well.

+ 0 — ➔ Reply



Rob 1 year ago

Should say I added a command to run Ltibootstrap in a step, but it doesn't autologin to even

+ 0 — ➔ Reply



Rob 1 year ago

ADK 10.1.26100.2454, w24h2, able to build image. when deploying it stalls after OS deployment StateRestore. Sticks me on admin login page, if i login, I can run the LTIBootStrap.vbs file in C root, image installs everything remaining, joins domain and ends on login screen, real Can't figure why it's stalling, any help would be appreciated. I can't seem to remedy getting stalling. Have plenty of auto logins, drivers are updated. I ran into this with the previous and so thought updating adk would fix. Nope.

+ 0 — ➔ Reply



Johan Arwidmark 1 year ago

🗨 Reply to [Rob](#)

Author

Only thing that comes to mind is a GPO that breaks the process.

+ 0 — ➔ Reply



Rob 1 year ago

🗨 Reply to [Johan Arwidmark](#)

I looked deeper and it was the wim. Had some lingering provisioned apps. I removed re-sysprepped and worked.

Thx

+ 1 — ➔ Reply



Gardea A. Jaywehgar 1 year ago

🗨 Reply to [Rob](#)

I am experiencing the same issue. Can you tell me the provisioned Apps that you

+ 0 — ➔ Reply

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